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CITY OF BERKELEY

BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL SPECIAL MEETING

JULY 29, 2025

>> MAYOR ISHII: WE ARE JUST WAITING ON -- AFTER THAT.

>> I CAN'T WAIT TO NOT HEAR THAT AGAIN.

>> MAYOR ISHII: I KNOW.

>> [INDISCERNIBLE]

>> OKAY. MAYOR, WE CAN START.

>> RECORDING IN PROGRESS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: WE GOOD? ALRIGHT. WE ARE READY. THANK YOU SO MUCH. TODAY IS TUESDAY, JULY 29TH, 2025 AND I AM CALLING TO ORDER THE SPECIAL MEETING OF THE BERKELEY CITY COUNCIL. CLERK, CAN YOU PLEASE TAKE THE ROLE?

>> CITY CLERK: YES. COUNCILMEMBER KESARWANI.

>> R. KESARWANI: HERE.

>> CITY CLERK: TAPLIN.

>> T. TAPLIN: PRESENT.

>> CITY CLERK: BARTLETT IS CURRENTLY ABSENT. TREGUB.

>> I. TREGUB: PRESENT.

>> CITY CLERK: O'KEEFE.

>> S. O'KEEFE: PRESENT.

>> CITY CLERK: BLACKABY.

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>> B. BLACKABY: HERE.

>> CITY CLERK: LUNAPARRA.

>> C. LUNAPARRA: HERE.

>> CITY CLERK: HUMBERT.

>> M. HUMBERT: PRESENT.

>> CITY CLERK: AND MAYOR ISHII.

>> MAYOR ISHII: HERE.

>> CITY CLERK: QUORUM IS PRESENT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THIS IS A SPECIAL MEETING, BUT WE WILL MOVE STRAIGHT ON TO THE CONSENT CALENDAR. IS THERE PUBLIC COMMENT ON CONSENT CALENDAR AND INFORMATION ITEMS ONLY? AND IF SO -- YEAH, THANK YOU. IF SO, PLEASE COME UP TO THE PODIUM HERE. AND I THINK BECAUSE WE -- IT LOOKS LIKE WE ONLY HAVE TWO FOLKS HERE, SO YOU WILL EACH HAVE TWO MINUTES TO SPEAK OR YOU ARE GOING TO SPEAK TOGETHER. YOU ARE GOING TO SPEAK FOR HIM. SOUNDS GOOD.

>> TWO MINUTES BEGINS NOW? OKAY. GREETINGS MAYOR AND THE COUNCIL. MY NAME IS -- [INDISCERNIBLE] AND I AM FROM LIVE FREE. WE ARE THE ORGANIZATION THAT IS HOLDING THE CONTRACT FOR THE GUN VIOLENCE PROGRAM, INTERVENTION PROGRAM FOR THE CITY OF BERKELEY. WE ARE HERE ON BEHALF OF A GRANT OPPORTUNITY THAT'S WE JUST ACQUIRED AND IT HAS TO GET YOUR APPROVAL FOR THE FUNDS TO BE RELEASED. THIS IS ADDITIONAL SERVICES TO EXPAND OUR CURRENT TEAM. WE CURRENTLY HAVE 2.5 LIFE COACHES AND OUTREACH WORKERS.

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WHEN I SAY 2.5, WE HAVE ONE CERTIFIED. WE HAVE TWO INDIVIDUALS WHO ARE 24 HOURS AROUND THE CLOCK WHO IS ONE OF THOSE INDIVIDUALS WHO AT THE MOMENT OF THE CRISIS CAN GET CALLED TO A SCENE AT 2:00 IN THE MORNING, 3 P.M. IN THE AFTERNOON, ANYTIME. WE WANT TO EXPAND THE OPPORTUNITY TO ADD TWO MORE INDIVIDUALS TO OUR ADDITIONAL TEAM, DEFINITELY MUCH NEEDED WORK AS WE ARE ADDRESSING A LOT OF HARM AND TRAUMA THAT INDIVIDUALS ARE FACING. I KNOW THAT YOU ALL AS A CITY COUNCIL MAY UNDERSTAND AT THIS CURRENT MOMENT THERE HAS NOT BEEN A GUN VIOLENCE HOMICIDE IN THE CITY OF BERKELEY, BUT I WANT TO LIFT UP THE FACT THERE ARE FOUR INDIVIDUALS FROM TIME TO TIME THAT WE GOT THIS CONTRACT THAT ARE RESIDENTS OF BERKELEY WHO LOST THEIR LIVES IN THE CITY OF OAKLAND. THROUGH THESE FUNDS WE HAVE BEEN ABLE TO SUPPORT FAMILIES DURING EXTREME MOMENTS OF TRAUMA AND HELPING INDIVIDUALS TO GET CONNECTED TO RESOURCES THROUGHOUT THE REGION AS WELL AS DO WHAT WE CAN TO KEEP ONGOING SUPPORT, SO IT'S IMPERATIVE THE GRANT IS DOMINATED AND ALLOWED TO BE EXECUTED AS IS STATED. BUT IT'S ALSO IMPORTANT TO KEEP THE INTEGRITY OF THE WORK THAT'S BEING BUILT HERE. I KNOW IT STARTED OFF AS A PILOT, BUT WE ARE DEFINITELY LOOKING TO CONTINUE THE WORK THAT WE ARE DOING. WE ARE ALSO SEEKING OTHER FUNDS AND HAVE A FEW APPLICATIONS IN CURRENTLY TO EXPAND THOSE GRANT OPPORTUNITIES SO WE CAN BE MORE PERMANENTLY AROUND AS A FIXTURE IN THE CITY OF

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BERKELEY AND LOOKING TO CONTINUE THIS GREAT WORK. RIGHT ON TIME.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU SO MUCH. APPRECIATE IT. THANK YOU. DID YOU HAVE A COMMENT ON CONSENT CALENDAR?

>> I DO. GOOD AFTERNOON, COUNCIL, MAYOR, CITY MANAGER. SOUNDS LIKE A GREAT PROGRAM. I GUESS THIS IS IN ITS SECOND YEAR, ANOTHER $1 MILLION. $1 MILLION, 450,000 OF THAT DOESN'T GO TO THESE GUYS. IT GOES TO TWO YEARS SALARY OF A POLICE ANALYST, ALMOST HALF. 450,000 FOR TWO YEARS. THAT'S A LOT OF COIN. AM I MISSING SOMETHING? THAT'S A FULLY LOADED, PART-TIME, TEMPORARY, I GUESS THERE IS NO PENSION. CAN WE GET A HIGH SCHOOL GRADUATE, COLLEGE GRADUATE, GRAD STUDENT FOR A BUCK AND A QUARTER A YEAR, THAT WOULD BE $250. THANK YOU.

>> MAYOR ISHII: THANK YOU. [BERKELEY TECHNICAL DIFFICULTIES] [NO AUDIO]

>> RECORDING STOPPED. [PLEASE STAND BY]

>> CITY CLERK: HELLO, BOARDROOM. THIS IS ROSE. THIS IS A ZOOM TEST. CAN THE ROOM HEAR ME? TESTING, TESTING. TESTING, TESTING, THIS IS A BOARDROOM TEST. CAN THE ROOM HEAR ME? THIS IS A BOARDROOM TEST? TESTING, TESTING, TESTING, ZOOM TEST. TESTING. THIS IS A ZOOM TEST. THIS IS A ZOOM TEST FOR THE BOARDROOM.

>> I WAS SPEAKING THROUGH THE MICROPHONE AND MY VOICE IS COMING THROUGH THE ROOM. IS THERE SOMETHING SUPPOSED TO BE COMING OUT? [INDISCERNIBLE]

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>> ROSE, I AM TALKING INTO THE PODIUM MIC, I AM JUST CURIOUS HOW WELL YOU CAN HEAR WHAT I AM SAYING.

>> CITY CLERK: HI, MIKE, THIS IS ROSE ON ZOOM. I CAN HEAR YOU SPEAKING RIGHT NOW.

>> CITY CLERK: WE CAN RESUME. MAYOR AND COUNCILMEMBERS MAY TURN ON THEIR VIDEO, AND WE WILL HAVE VIDEO ON FOR PEOPLE RESERVE THE COMMENT, WE WILL TURN THE LAPTOP THERE, SO I THINK WE CAN RESUME.

>> RECORDING IN PROGRESS.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY. WE ARE GOING TO GIVE THIS A SHOT. I CAN TELL MY VIDEO IS FROZEN, SO GREAT START. LET'S SEE WHERE WERE WE? I THINK THAT WE ARE ON RIGHT NOW, SO -- SORRY.

>> CITY CLERK: JUST A MOTION.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YEAH, WE WILL TAKE THAT MOTION AGAIN, THOUGH BECAUSE I THINK IT HAPPENED BEFORE THE ZOOM WENT OUT. SO IS THERE A MOTION TO APPROVE THE CONSENT CALENDAR.

>> I MOVE APPROVAL OF THE CONSENT CALENDAR.

>> SECOND.

>> MAYOR ISHII: IS COUNCILMEMBER BLACKABY ONLINE?

>> CITY CLERK: I DON'T SEE HIM ONLINE, NO. SO WE DON'T HAVE TO DO THE ROLL CALL.

>> MAYOR ISHII: OKAY. IN THAT CASE, SORRY. I AM MESSING WITH MY PHONE, IN THAT CASE ARE THERE ANY QUESTIONS TO PRESENT THE

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CONSENT CALENDAR? WITH THAT, THEN THE MOTION WILL PASS AND WE MOVE ON TO THE ACTION CALENDAR. WE ARE GOING TO HAVE BOTH PRESENTATIONS HAPPEN, AND THEN WE WILL TAKE QUESTIONS AND PUBLIC COMMENT. SO MAY WE HAVE OUR FIRST PRESENTERS COME UP, PLEASE?

>> MADAM MAYOR, I AM CONNECTING TO THE INTERNET TO SHOW MY SLIDES. [INDISCERNIBLE].

>> I CAN START IF YOU WANT.

>> MAYOR ISHII: YEAH, THANKS. I WILL ASK THAT OUR CITY AUDITOR, IF YOU COULD PULL UP YOUR PRESENTATION TO GET IT SET UP BECAUSE I KNOW IT MAY TAKE A MINUTE TO SET UP THE HOT SPOT, THANK YOU.

>> THANK YOU MADAM MAYOR AND COUNCIL. WE HAVE A PRESENTATION FORTHCOMING ON THE CITY OF BERKELEY SYSTEM, BUT I WANTED TO START OFF BY SAYING SOMEWHAT THE OBVIOUS POINT THAT HOMELESSNESS IS REALLY SERIOUS FAILURE OF OUR DEMOCRACY AS A COUNTRY, AND AT THE LOCAL LEVEL, WE SEE THE CRISIS OF HOMELESSNESS IN CITIES THROUGHOUT THIS COUNTRY, HERE IN BERKELEY -- [INDISCERNIBLE] OBVIOUSLY, AND THE -- FIGURING OUT HOW TO MAKE IT LESS TERRIBLE THAN IT IS FALLS TO CITY STAFF AND COMMUNITY MAYBES LIKE A AS WELL AS CITY COUNCIL TO MAKE POLICY TO HELP GUIDE THE WORK THAT WE DO. THE TRAGEDY OF THE SITUATION IS THAT PEOPLE ON OUR STREETS DIE AND HAVE HARD AND MISERABLE LIVES AND THEY HAVE NEGATIVE IMPACTS OFTEN OF BUSINESSES AND THE HOUSED PEOPLE WHO LIVE NEARBY, AND SO THERE IS A VERY CONSTANT TENSION AND

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STRUGGLE THAT WE ARE ALL WRESTLING WITH EMOTIONALLY, PHYSICALLY AND FINANCIALLY. I WANT TO THANK OUR HOMELESS RESPONSE TEAM FOR THEIR DEDICATION TO THIS ISSUE WITH THE LEADERSHIP OF PETER, BUT ALSO -- [INDISCERNIBLE] AND SO ON AND JOSH WHO IS AT THE TABLE AS WELL AS -- [INDISCERNIBLE] THROUGHOUT THE CITY. THERE IS A TEAM PUBLIC WORKS AND PARKS & RECREATION, TO THE POLICE DEPARTMENT, TO HEALTH AND COMMUNITY SERVICES ALL WORK TOGETHER TO TRY TO MAKE THIS SITUATION LESS BAD THAN IT IS. AND IN MY ESTIMATION, THE WORKS THAT HAPPENS HERE IN THE CITY OF BERKELEY IS, AT LEAST THE WORK THE HRT TEAM DOES WITH THE OTHER DEPARTMENTS IS SOMETHING THAT I APPRECIATE. I KNOW HOW HARD THAT WORK IS, AND I THINK WE ARE LUCKY TO HAVE THIS TEAM THAT PUTS SUCH A CONCERTED EFFORT IN THIS AREA. WITH THAT, WE HAVE OUR TEAM OF PRESENTERS HERE TO PROVIDE MORE DETAIL ON OUR HOMELESS SYSTEM AND I WILL TURN IT OVER TO THE ASSISTANT TO THE CITY MANAGER, PETER RADU.

>> THANK YOU. THANK YOU CITY MANAGER. I WAS CONNECTED MOMENTARILY AND IT DROPPED, SO I AM NOT ABLE TO SHARE SLIDES. IF YOU -- IF IT'S OKAY TO MAYBE JUST TAKE ANOTHER SECOND TO SEE IF I CAN CONNECT, IF NOT, WE WILL FIGURE OUT A PATH FORWARD. [INDISCERNIBLE]

>> FIND A WAY TO SHOW THE SLIDES. THERE ARE TWO OF THEM. [INDISCERNIBLE]

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>> I WANT TO SINCERELY APOLOGIZE FOR THE DELAY THERE. I THINK WE HAVE MANAGED A PATH FORWARD, SO THANK YOU MAYOR, AND COUNCIL FOR THE OPPORTUNITY -- [INDISCERNIBLE] MY NAME IS [INDISCERNIBLE] MANAGER OF SERVICES AND I AM HAPPY TO BE HERE TO ADDRESS WHAT THE CITY OF BERKELEY DOES TO ADDRESS HOMELESSNESS. WE ARE HERE TO PRESENT THE DETAILS ARE JOSH -- [INDISCERNIBLE] COORDINATOR FOR THE CITY MANAGER'S OFFICE AND THEN [INDISCERNIBLE], OUR HOUSING SPECIALIST FROM THE HEALTH, HOUSING COMMUNITY SERVICES DEPARTMENT. A QUICK NOTE BEFORE WE GET STARTED, WHICH IS THAT WHILE OUR PRESENTATION TODAY WILL FOCUS ON OUR OVERVIEW OF THE OUR HOMELESS SYSTEM, THE REPORT SUBMITTED TO YOU IS MORE EXPANSIVE AS WE WANTED TO TAKE THIS OPPORTUNITY TO A NUMBER OF PIECES IN THE REFERRAL FROM CITY COUNCIL'S MAY 20TH, 2025 ROLLER TO THE CITY MANAGER ON HOMELESSNESS. THIS INCLUDES AN OVERVIEW OF OUR SYSTEM PERFORMANCE WITH NEEDS AND GAPS, A GEOGRAPHIC EQUITY MAP OF HOMELESS SERVICES AND APPEAR UPDATE ON THE CITY'S POSITION ON HOMELESS PLANNING. FOR TIME TODAY, OUR PRESENTATION WON'T GO INTO ALL OF THESE AREAS, BUT WE WOULD MORE THAN HAPPY TO ANSWER ANY QUESTIONS THAT YOU MAY HAVE ABOUT ANY OF THEM. WITH THAT I WILL TURN THINGS OVER TO JOSH AND [INDISCERNIBLE].

>> THANKS. GOOD AFTERNOON, [INDISCERNIBLE] TODAY'S PRESENTATION WE ARE GOING TO FOCUS ON HOW BERKELEY -- [

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INDISCERNIBLE] STRATEGY AND INFRASTRUCTURE NEEDED TO RESPOND. AS YOU ALL KNOW HOMELESSNESS IS VERY COMPLEX AND SHAPED BY FORCES SUCH AS REGIONAL TRENDS, RACIAL AND ECONOMIC INEQUALITIES AND UNDER RESOURCED -- [INDISCERNIBLE]. BUT THROUGH COORDINATION BERKELEY -- TODAY'S PRESENTATION WILL WALK THROUGH WHAT WE HAVE ACCOMPLISHED, WHERE WE ARE SEEING IMPACTS AND WHO IS AT RISK OF KEY -- [INDISCERNIBLE]. NEXT SLIDE, PLEASE. SO WHAT'S THE PROBLEM? BERKELEY LIKE EVERY CITY IN THE REGION HAS A TROUBLING REALITY. [INDISCERNIBLE] SAFETY AND INSTABILITY AND WITH THE MAIN PROGRESS THE CHALLENGE REMAINS STAGGERING. THAT SAID WE ARE SEEING REAL SHIFTS IN A DIRECTION. [INDISCERNIBLE] ANY PREVIOUS YEAR. AT THE SAME TIME WE SAW LEAST NUMBER OF PEOPLE STANDING ON THE STREETS, A SIGNIFICANT MILESTONE -- LOW BARRIER -- [INDISCERNIBLE] INTERIM HEALTH -- ACROSS THE REGION FOR EVERY PERSON WHO ENTERS HOMELESSNESS, THERE ARE THREE OTHERS WHO FALL INTO IT FOR THE FIRST TIME. [INDISCERNIBLE] CONTINUE TO SEE PEOPLE ON OUR STREETS WHO ARE MOST IMPACTED. 50% -- [INDISCERNIBLE] OUR POPULATION IS BLACK, DESPITE BLACK RESIDENTS MAKE UP 8% OF THE CITY OVERALL. WE SEE RISING RATES OF PEOPLE WITH DISABILITIES. [INDISCERNIBLE] SERVING THESE POPULATIONS AND THE PROGRESS WE HAVE MADE REQUIRE A COORDINATED RESPONSE ACROSS MULTIPLE SYSTEMS. OTHERWISE, WE RISK ON -- [INDISCERNIBLE]. THE PATH FORWARD IS SUSTAINED, REGIONAL

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RESPONSE, BUT ALSO LOCAL ACTION, WHICH WE WILL WALK THROUGH IN THE NEXT SLIDES. AS MENTIONED, INFLAME IS FACING A FISCAL CLIFF FOR SEVERAL HOMELESS RESOURCES. NEXT SLIDE, PLEASE. PROGRAM RESPONSIBLE -- [INDISCERNIBLE] FEDERAL FUNDS. WE -- [INDISCERNIBLE] MANY OF THE PEOPLE IN SHELTER AT RISK RETURNING TO THE STREETS. ADDITIONAL FUNDING LONGSTANDING PROGRAMS -- [INDISCERNIBLE] THE WORK AHEAD WILL REQUIRE HARD CHOICES, BUT ALSO CREATE SOLUTIONS AND -- [INDISCERNIBLE] SUCCESSFUL. FLEX SLIDE, PLEASE. AND YET IMMENSE ALL OF THESE CHALLENGES, WE MADE REMARKABLE PROGRESS. IN -- [INDISCERNIBLE] 45% CHANGE OF HOMELESS. [INDISCERNIBLE] COORDINATED OUTREACH, INVESTMENTS AND -- [INDISCERNIBLE] ACROSS DEPARTMENTS. ADDRESSED THE NEEDS OF OUR MOST VULNERABLE RESIDENTS AND REMOVED THE BARRIERS, PEOPLE WILL TAKE THOSE OPPORTUNITIES. WHEN WE OFFER TRADITIONAL SHELTER -- [INDISCERNIBLE] 40%. WHEN WE OFFER LOW BARRIER SHELTER, WE SEE IT JUMP TO 80%. THESE ARE PROGRAMS THAT ARE AT RISK OF LOSING FUNDING. IT'S A REMINDER HOW FRAGILE THIS -- [INDISCERNIBLE]. NEXT SLIDE. COORDINATION EFFORTS, IN 2021 -- [INDISCERNIBLE] THREE-PRONGED. THIS STRATEGY HAS THREE COMPONENTS, PREVENTION SO HOMELESSNESS DOESN'T HAPPEN IN THE FIRST PLACE AND INTERIM HOUSING AND -- [INDISCERNIBLE]

>> PREVENTING IT FROM HAPPENING IN THE FIRST PLACE AND -- [INDISCERNIBLE]. IN 2025, BERKELEY SERVED MORE THAN 940 RENTER

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HOUSEHOLDS WITH ASSISTANCE. [INDISCERNIBLE] TO REVIEW OUR POLICIES TO ENSURE THAT WE ARE ABLE TO SERVE AS MANY HOUSEHOLDS AS POSSIBLE. FISCAL YEAR 21 THROUGH FISCAL YEAR 24, WE RELIED HEAVILY ON THE FEDERAL FUNDS THAT WERE -- HIGHER AND SERVING MORE PEOPLE. HOWEVER, DUE TO THIS FLEXIBILITY GLOBAL FUNDING IS MORE BENEFICIAL TO THE HOUSING RETENTION PROGRAM. IN 2022 THE CITY AND -- [INDISCERNIBLE] PROGRAM THAT PROVIDES UP TO $1800 A MONTH FOR UP TO THREE YEARS TO MOST AT RISK RESIDENTS AND UNHOUSED PEOPLE WERE UNLIVABLE FOR PERMANENT SUPPORT HOUSING. SERVED MORE THAN 50 HOUSEHOLDS REMAIN STABLY HOUSED. PROVIDES A SAFETY NET FOR THOSE MOST VULNERABLE TO RETURN TO THE STREETS. THE VISION FOR THE PROGRAM COULD EXPAND FOR THE FUTURE. HIGHEST RISK -- DISABLED AND HOUSEHOLDS WITH -- [INDISCERNIBLE] NEXT SLIDE, PLEASE. THIS SLIDE SHOWS THE EVICTION RATES IN ALAMEDA COUNTY. -- FROM OUR RESIDENTS BERKELEY HOMELESSNESS AND OUR NEIGHBORING CITIES. IT'S IMPORTANT TO NOTE BERKELEY -- AND AVOID TO LEGAL EVICTIONS AFTER THE PANDEMIC MORATORIUM WAS LIFTED. BERKELEY HAS LOWEST IN THE COUNTY AND THAT HAS A LOT TO DO WITH THE VISION PASSED BY CITY COUNCIL. [INDISCERNIBLE] IN 2024, AVERAGED FOR EVICTIONS AND BERKELEY -- LOST ZOOM. [NO AUDIO] CONFERENCE ROOM MIC IS MUTED. [NO AUDIO]

>> RECORDING STOPPED.

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